Rose stared at the soldier's face, shaded as it was by the dark peak jutting out from his stiff cap. He stepped closer.

"I'm not drawing the boat, but the bridge," she said, her hand shaking as she lifted the sketchbook to show him.

"*Verboten*!" he repeated, his voice harsher. "*Fräulein ist eine Spionin.*"

Two years into the Occupation, her German was good enough to catch the accusation that hung in the air like a noose around her neck. His black-gloved hand reached for her arm.

Rose jumped back. A bolt of panic shot through her as she hurled the pencil case at his face, buying a few precious seconds to stand and run.

"*Halt, halt!*"

She darted up the steep embankment, heart pounding. Slipping on the cobbles, she lost her balance and the sketchbook fell from her hands. There wasn't time to stop. At Rue au Lin, she raced past the female workers leaving the vinegar factory. She didn't need to turn back to see if he was following—she heard the clip of the metal tips on his boots on the pavement close behind. Her adrenaline surged. If caught, she'd be thrown in prison for spying. She ran faster until she was nearly out of breath and a stitch formed in her side.

"Café du Marché," a man's voice called out. "Kitchen exit."

Up ahead on her left, the green sign for the Café du Marché swung above a door. With no time to hesitate, Rose entered. The soldier's footsteps faded.

Inside the restaurant, she avoided eye contact, swerving around the half-full tables. At the far end, red double doors swung open and a waiter, carrying a tureen of soup, appeared. She wove her way to the kitchen. Hit with the odor of fried onions and liver, the clanging of copper pans and the oppressive heat from the ovens, she felt a headache pulse behind her eyes. Where was the door? Léa always said not to trust anyone. Sweat slid down Rose's back. What if there wasn't another exit and the man on the street had set her up, leaving her trapped?

A draft of cool air rushed in and she maneuvered around the ovens to the rear of the kitchen, where a door stood ajar. She looked out to make sure the German soldier wasn't in the alley behind the restaurant. But the alley was blocked off from Rue au Lin with a single opening to a road farther along. The only way for the soldier to find her would be if he'd seen her